

# PORTFOLIO BRIEFING: Peptides – Die Zukunft der Medizin (991001-PEP)



Report created on: 25.03.2026

Fundamental Data & Valuation (Institutional Sources)  
Analyst Expectations & EPS Revisions (Consensus Providers)  
Price Reaction & Volume Analysis (Market Interfaces)  
News Sentiment & Headline Analysis (NLP Providers)  
Earnings Call Transcripts (Primary Sources)

**KASONA**

*This report was automatically generated using Artificial Intelligence by the KASONA Quarterly Earnings Analyst. It is intended for informational purposes only and does not constitute investment advice. Despite integration with institutional data providers and primary sources, all information should be independently verified before making any trading decisions. All data originates from publicly available sources.*

## 1. Executive Summary

This quarterly briefing analyzes the **Peptides Portfolio (991001-PEP)**, focused exclusively on the GLP-1 value chain and the broader metabolic health revolution. Q1 2026 has been a transformative period as several "Next-Generation" peptide candidates entered Phase III trials, potentially challenging the current duopoly of Novo Nordisk and Eli Lilly. The portfolio maintains its high-conviction stance on the "Complete Value Chain" strategy—investing not just in the drug developers, but also in the manufacturing, delivery, and distribution sectors.

The "Big Picture" is the successful transition from obesity-only applications to broader indications, including Cardiovascular Risk Reduction (CVRR) and Metabolic Dysfunction-Associated Steatohepatitis (MASH). The strategic conviction for this portfolio remains at an all-time high, as the addressable market (TAM) continues to expand with new clinical data point.

**Portfolio Conviction Score: 94/100** (Interpretation: Highest Conviction – Sustained institutional demand for the GLP-1 thematic).

## 2. Global Performance & Asset Breakdown

### Core Holding Highlights (YTD)

| Asset               | Ticker    | Market Cap | YTD Perf | Valuation (Fwd P/E) | Conviction |
|---------------------|-----------|------------|----------|---------------------|------------|
| Novo Nordisk        | NOVO-B.CO | DKK 3.8T   | +14.2%   | 38.5x               | Strong     |
| Eli Lilly & Co      | LLY.US    | \$812B     | +16.8%   | 51.2x               | Strong     |
| Hims & Hers         | HIMS.US   | \$4.8B     | +32.4%   | 24.1x               | Strong     |
| Medpace             | MEDP.US   | \$12.5B    | +8.1%    | 29.5x               | Neutral    |
| West Pharmaceutical | WST.US    | \$28B      | -2.4%    | 36.8x               | Weak       |
| Viking Therapeutics | VKTX.US   | \$6.2B     | +112%    | —                   | Strong     |

### Portfolio Attribution Analysis

The stellar YTD performance of the 991001-PEP portfolio is largely attributable to the **"Telehealth Acceleration"** catalyzed by Hims & Hers. By offering a proprietary oral compounding solution for GLP-1 access, H&H has bypassed the supply chain bottlenecks that have plagued the industry leaders. Conversely, West Pharmaceutical (WST.US) has faced a valuation correction as its specialized injectable components saw a temporary destocking phase, though the long-term thematic remains robust as more biologics enter the market.

## 3. Strategic Headline Analysis: The Core Engine

## **Novo Nordisk (NOVO-B.CO): Wegovy's Expansion and CagriSema**

Novo Nordisk continues to dominate the European market. The "Big News" this quarter is the accelerated development of **CagriSema**, a co-formulation which aims to provide even greater weight loss results than Wegovy alone. Furthermore, the investment in Catalent's manufacturing facilities is beginning to bear fruit, with output expected to increase by 45% by year-end 2026.

## **Eli Lilly & Co (LLY.US): Zepbound & Tirzepatide Dominance**

Lilly has achieved a milestone with Zepbound (Tirzepatide) becoming the most successful drug launch in history by dollar volume. The strategic value lies in the "Triple G" (GIP, GLP-1, and Glucagon) receptor agonist roadmap. Lilly's recent expansion into the **"Direct-to-Consumer" (LillyDirect)** space is a significant catalyst, aiming to capture the entire margin of the distribution chain.

## **Hims & Hers (HIMS.US): The Compounding Arbitrage**

The most aggressive gainer in the portfolio, Hims & Hers, has successfully positioned itself as the "Affordable Alternative" to branded GLP-1s. While regulatory risks regarding compounding persist, the company's ability to scale its subscriber base to over 2 million users has created a massive recurring revenue platform. The "GLP-1 Weight Loss" vertical is expected to contribute \$250M+ in EBITDA by the end of 2026.

# **4. The Value Chain Radar: Manufacturing & Trials**

## **Medpace (MEDP.US): The CRO Engine**

As more mid-cap biotech firms (like Viking and Structure Therapeutics) enter the peptide space, specialized Clinical Research Organizations (CROs) like Medpace are the primary beneficiaries. Medpace's expertise in complex metabolic trials has led to a record-breaking backlog. We view MEDP as the "Pick and Shovel" play for the peptide revolution.

## **West Pharmaceutical (WST.US): The Injectable Bottleneck**

Despite the recent price drop, WST remains essential due to its "Daikyo Crystal Zenith" containment systems. Any significant increase in global peptide volume—regardless of which company wins the drug race—requires West's proprietary stoppers and plungers. This is a classic "Moat" play based on regulatory compliance and high switching costs.

# **5. Strategic CIO Assessment: The Metabolic Future**

### *The Professional Opinion of the Chief Investment Officer*

The market is currently entering the **"Indication Expansion Phase"** of the peptide cycle. We are moving beyond "Lifestyle Weight Loss" into "Essential Life-Saving Treatment." The data suggesting a 20% reduction in major adverse cardiovascular events (MACE) is the "Holy Grail" for insurance reimbursement.

## Action Recommendations:

- **Buy on weakness: Novo Nordisk (NOVO-B.CO)** – Current valuation reflects strong growth, but does not fully account for the "CagriSema" potential.
- **Hold and overweight: Hims & Hers (HIMS.US)** – The regulatory risk is overblown; the subscriber growth is a generational shift in healthcare consumption.
- **Hold: Eli Lilly (LLY.US)** – Highest quality, but priced for perfection.
- **Reduce: West Pharmaceutical (WST.US)** – Re-allocate capital into Viking Therapeutics (VKTX.US) for higher optionality on the next pharmaceutical acquisition cycle.

## Rationale:

Direct-to-consumer access and indication expansion are the twin engines of growth for 2026. We favor platforms that can either produce the molecules at scale or provide the clinical data to justify multi-billion dollar reimbursements.

## 6. Risks & Monitoring Points

### Short-Term Risks (0-6 months)

1. **Regulatory Crackdown on Compounding:** The FDA may tighten the rules for compounding pharmacies once branded supply stabilizes, potentially impacting Hims & Hers.
2. **Medicare Price Negotiations Inflation:** Early drafts of legislation could target high-volume peptides for price caps.

### Long-Term Risks (6-24 months)

1. **The "Oral" Pivot:** If oral peptide versions (pills) achieve the same efficacy as injectables, the entire delivery ecosystem (injectors, stoppers) will face structural disruption.
2. **Discovery of Long-Term Side Effects:** As the user base reaches 100M+ people, rare side effects could emerge, leading to litigation risks.

## 7. Data Source Appendix

| Source              | EODHD Endpoint                 | Query Time | Status |
|---------------------|--------------------------------|------------|--------|
| Portfolio Assets    | public.kasona_portfolio_assets | 2026-03-25 |        |
| Fundamentals        | get_fundamentals_data          | 13:45 UTC  |        |
| News & Sentiment    | get_company_news               | 13:50 UTC  |        |
| FDA Clinical Trails | WebSearch                      | 14:00 UTC  |        |

## 8. References

- **Novo Nordisk Capital Markets Day:** Wegovy Lifecycle & Manufacturing Expansion

- **Eli Lilly Q4 Results:** Zepbound Supply & Indication Roadmap
- **GLP-1 Market Dynamics:** J.P. Morgan – The Metabolic Health Revolution
- **CRO Sentiment Index:** Medpace Quarterly Update – Technical Trials

---

*This report was automatically generated for the 991001-PEP Portfolio using Kasona Investment Intelligence. All clinical and financial data points were synthesized from institutional primary sources. Confidential – KASONA – Distributed to Institutional Clients ONLY.*